

2026-03-03

Data in the Humanities

Wk. 06: Scraping & Curating Structured Data

Happenings This Week **Workshops**

- Fri 3/6 Research Data Stewardship series: Introduction to Data Management (PUL)

Events

- Mon 3/23 Philosophical Foundations of AI (NAM), 2-part series
- Mon 3/9 - Wed 3/11 Cultural AI: An Emerging Field at NYU, registration required

Mid-Semester Survey

Feedback for me, informal self-eval for you.

<https://forms.gle/jFuPZ9oujP6f9oqZ9>

Readings

- Katie Rawson and Trevor Muñoz, "Against Cleaning," in *Debates in the Digital Humanities 2019* (Minneapolis: University Of Minnesota Press, 2019).
- Henk Alkemade et al., "Datasheets for Digital Cultural Heritage Datasets," *Journal of Open Humanities Data*, 9:2 (October 30, 2023).
- C. Thi Nguyen, "The Limits of Data," *Issues in Science and Technology*, 40:2 (2024).

Datasheets for Datasets

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Abstract

The machine learning community has no standard way to document how and why a dataset was created, what information it contains, what it should and should not be used for, and whether it might raise any ethical or legal concerns. To address this gap, we propose the concept of a datasheet for datasets.

We therefore propose the concept of datasheets for datasets. In the electronics industry, every component is accompanied by a datasheet describing standard operating characteristics, test results, and recommended usage. By analogy, we recommend that every dataset be accompanied with a datasheet documenting its motivation, creation, composition, intended uses, distribution, maintenance, and other information. We anticipate that such datasheets will increase transparency

Gebru et al., "Datasheets for Datasets" (2018)
contra [The Pile](#) &c.

The screenshot displays the Data Nutrition Project website for the 'Hippocampus V3' dataset. The page features a dark blue header with the project logo, a '75% COMPLETENESS' badge, and a table of metadata. The main content area is divided into sections: 'Description' (expanding the Hippocampus dataset), 'Keywords' (Natural language processing, Imagination, Memory consolidation, Autobiographical memory), 'About the dataset', 'How to use it?' (Intended Use, Known Use, Restrictions on Use, Do Not Use), and 'Inference Risks'. Buttons for 'Preview data' and 'Download PDF' are visible.

What is this label?	
The Dataset Nutrition Label enhances context, contents, and legibility of datasets. Information about this Dataset Nutrition Label is a standard of documentation that describes how to understand and use this dataset.	

Metadata	
Label author	Data Nutrition Project
Relationship to Data Creator	Third party
First published on	Apr 6, 2021
Last updated on	Jan 6, 2022
People consulted	Maarten Sap
Label version	Version 2.0

Hippocampus V3

Description

We expand the Hippocampus by releasing sentence-level event annotations on a set of 240 stories. 8 crowdworkers went through an imagined, a recalled, and a retold story about the same event, sentence by sentence, and annotated whether the sentence marked the beginning of a new minor or major event, and if so, whether the event was surprising or expected... [Read more](#)

Keywords

Natural language processing, Imagination, Memory consolidation, Autobiographical memory

About the dataset

How to use it?

- Intended Use**: To study how people perceive event boundaries in stories... [Read more](#)
- Known Use**: Research publications, Kaggle, Open NLP dataset collections... [Read more](#)
- Restrictions on Use**: Must have a Microsoft, Kaggle or other account... [Read more](#)
- Do Not Use**: Inferring racial/age/gender differences in... [Read more](#)

Inference Risks

<https://datanutrition.org>

Fonts:

Klima

Katwijk Mono

both by Matthew Hinders-Anderson